

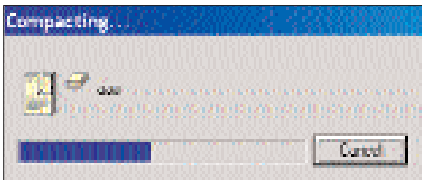
30Minutes Expert

Operation cleanup

Many of us have unmanageable mailboxes overflowing with official mail we don't want to delete, yet see no use for it in the immediate future. Thousands of messages fill up the mail client, making it painfully slow, unstable and quite a mess. Here's how you can reduce some of the load and cut out the overheads, without losing any important mail.

Outlook Express

When you delete a message from a folder or move it to another one in Outlook Express, the information of the message is still maintained in the original folder. Over time, this accumulates to a lot of unnecessary wasted space. The simplest way to slim down this junk space is to click **File > Folders > Compact All Folders**. Clicking on Compact will clean out only the current folder. Unlike Outlook, Outlook Express cannot distinguish old mail from the current, letting only the latter load.



Compacting folders in Outlook Express

Outlook

In Microsoft Outlook, you can manage your incoming e-mails and message folders by configuring the options just once. You can configure the archiving feature to remove all your old e-mail to a separate file so that you see only the recent messages and load the older ones when needed. This way your e-mail client is no longer bogged down by the huge number of messages and you can still retain

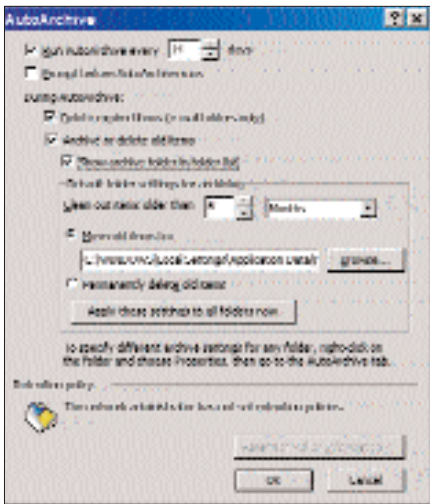


An easy way to set up different automatic archiving options is to first configure the default settings for all folders with the most common options, then modify the properties of the ones that need to be different

all your important information and access it any time you want to.

To set up automatic archiving in Outlook, open **Tools > Options** and switch to the Other tab. Here, click the AutoArchive button to set it to run at specific intervals, the default being every 14 days. You can set the older e-mail to be moved to an archive folder, or permanently delete it. Click the 'Apply these settings to all folders now' button and you are all done.

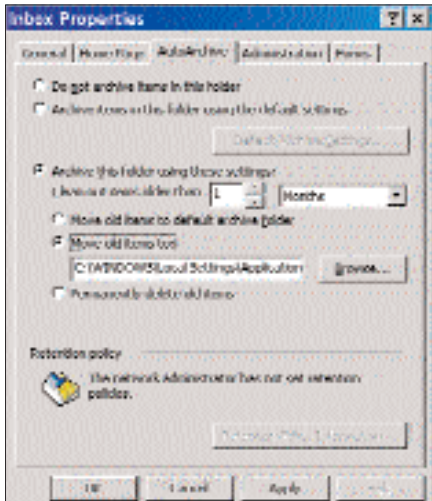
If you maintain several message folders such as 'Boss', 'Friends' and 'Research', some of them may contain



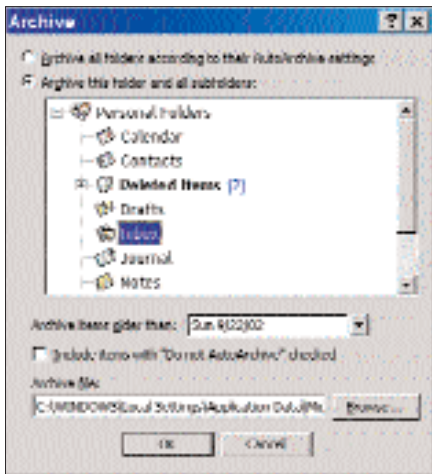
Set up automatic archiving for all folders in Outlook

communication you need to refer to more often than others. Thus, typically the 'Boss' folder needs to be archived less frequently than the 'Friends' folder. This is especially true if you have a lot of message rules that automatically direct your e-mail to the correct folders.

It is possible to set up different archiving options



You can have different archiving options for each folder



Manually archive folders in Outlook

for each individual folder. All you have to do is right-click on the particular folder and click on Properties. Switch to the AutoArchive tab and set up the frequency and archiving rules as per your requirements. If you want even more control over the archiving functions, you can manually archive the folder of choice by selecting it and clicking on **File > Archive**.

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